

THE DM REFERENCE GUIDE

The King's Crusade

OVERVIEW

This document is the table's working reference, not a fifth telling of the setting or the story. It gathers three things a DM needs at hand and does not want to hunt for across twelve other files: a one-page map of the whole campaign's shape, an index of every stat block already built so a name can be found without a search, and the Branch Ledger — the compiled record of every tracked divergence, module by module, with a blank column for what actually happened at this table. Everything here is drawn from the sourcebook and the eleven module slots; nothing here is new canon, and none of the campaign's deliberately open questions have been quietly settled to make this document tidier.

Use it during play as a quick-lookup: which module a name belongs to, what CR a recurring stat block sits at, what got decided last session that this session might reference. Use the Branch Ledger after every session, not just at the end of the campaign — an entry filled in while it is fresh is worth more than one reconstructed from memory two modules later.

CAMPAIGN AT A GLANCE

Eleven module slots (twelve files — Module Two forks by road and only one half is played). Starting level 5, milestone advancement, built for a party of 4–6. Each module's own Overview carries a scene-by-scene pacing table against its five-hour budget; this table is the one-line shape of the whole march.

Module	Title	Core Content
1	The Muster	Duncarrow; the wyvern at Greywatch; the road choice — sea or mountain.
2A	The Sea Road	Warden Thane's hold; the port of Calanthe and its fate.
2B	The Mountain Road	The Ashgate Ford; Baron Vell's toll-keep.
3	Landfall	First ground in occupied Elduvaine; the checkpoint; Wyn Alder.
4	The Coalition	Sennoch Hall rescue; the Ward freed; Doria Kell and Norvatch.
5	The Road to Vindana	The second king's drowning resolved; mourning at the Standing Water.
6	The Siege of Vindana: Investment	Engines raised; the supply raid; First Assault.
7	The Siege of Vindana: The Breaking	Marshal Drell's fate; the city breaks; Xavier becomes the Wyvernheart.
8	Held Ground	Securing Vindana; the Magistrate freed.
9	The Field Battle	General Voss's army met in the open and broken; Tam Ondry.
10	The Approach	The march on Caer Ysolde; the Regent; Norvatch names its price.
11	The Decision at the Gates (Final)	Caer Ysolde falls; Maedoc Vale confronted; hold or set down.

PEOPLES AT A GLANCE

Every realm is mixed; the table is who a party actually meets there and in what proportion. The load-bearing rule is that nobody in this campaign is their species — dwarves hunt wyverns in Harrowmark and keep contracts in Norvatch, and orcs fight on both sides of this war without a single NPC remarking on it.

Realm or faction	Who you meet	What the place makes of them
Harrowmark	Humans, dwarves, orcs; half-orcs and half-elves throughout	Wyvern country. Dwarves on the pikes, orcs on the ropes, nine centuries unchanged. All magic is worked, professional and carried in a person, because the land does nothing.
Elduvaine	Elves, gnomes, halflings, humans — plus dryads, sprites and satyrs	Elves keep the Kept Season orchards; gnomes clerk the Archive and cut the light-stone; halflings hold the river parishes and supply the whole kingdom's manners.
Oksitan	Humans, dragonborn nobility, half-elves at court	River and horse country. Dragonborn houses have held the same fords for longer than the records go back.
Auberitz	Humans, gnomes, halflings	The duchy that builds things. The coalition's siege train is theirs, gnome-designed and halfling-quartermastered.
Norvatch	Dwarves, tieflings, humans	Guild-law country. A bargain is written, witnessed and binding, and honoured to the letter no matter what the letter turns out to have meant.
The occupation	Hobgoblin core; orc, human, goblin auxiliaries; Elduvish clerks	A hired legion, not a horde. Permits, a published grain levy, competent officers, no fanatics. They are employees.

STAT BLOCK INDEX

Every named stat block built so far, in order of first appearance. “SRD base” names the unmodified SRD creature a block was built from — renamed blocks keep the base creature's numbers exactly and change only name, flavor text, and (where noted in the module) minor cosmetic description. The Occupation Guard is defined in Module 3, reprinted in full in Module 4 because that module's own fight needs it to hand, and pointed at by reference in Modules 6, 7, 9 and 11.

Name	SRD Base	CR (XP)	AC	HP	Module
Wyvern	Wyvern, unmodified	6 (2,300)	13	110	1 — The Muster
Warden Ivor Thane	Veteran, renamed	3 (700)	17	58	2A — The Sea Road
Thane's Guard	Bandit, unmodified	1/8 (25)	12	11	2A — The Sea Road
Baron Osgar Vell	Bandit Captain, renamed	2 (450)	15	65	2B — The Mountain Road
Ashgate Scout	Scout, unmodified	1/2 (100)	13	16	2B — The Mountain Road
Occupation Guard	Guard, unmodified	1/8 (25)	16	11	3 — Landfall (reused: 4, 6, 7, 9, 11)
Marshal Ossian Drell	Veteran, renamed	3 (700)	17	58	6 — Vindana: Investment (returns: 7)
General Ilyana Voss	Gladiator, renamed	5 (1,800)	16	112	9 — The Field Battle
Maedoc Vale	Archmage, renamed	12 (8,400)	15	99	11 — The Decision at the Gates

A stat block's full traits and actions live only in its own module's script — this index is for finding the right file fast, not for running the creature from this page alone.

CREATURES CALLED FOR BY REFERENCE

These are used by name in the modules without a reprinted block, because they are unmodified SRD entries a DM can look up in seconds. All are 2014 SRD.

Creature	CR (XP)	Where it is called for
Kobold	1/8 (25)	The old workings above Ashgate (2B, optional); Vindana's undercity (6). Trap-layers and negotiators, not a slaughter.
Winter Wolf	3 (700)	The Held Winter (5, optional). Hunts the wood's edges.
Troll	5 (1,800)	The Held Winter (5, optional). Has taken the orchard-keeper's cottage. Regeneration is the fight.
Dryad	1 (200)	The Held Winter (5, optional). Not an encounter — a conversation, and the campaign's grief in one NPC.
Sprite	1/4 (50)	Caerwyn's orchard hedge (3). Four inches of extremely rude opinion. Pure texture.
Ogre	2 (450)	The mountain road (2B, optional), as an alternative to the kobold workings.

THE ELDUVISH WONDERS

Four habits made portable, and the campaign's best treasure. Ordinary inside Elduvaine, astonishing everywhere else.

Wonder	What it does	First available
Standing-stone lamp	Gnome-cut stone that holds daylight poured into it and gives it back for hours.	Module 3, from Caerwyn's baker
Flask of Listening Water	Holds what is said at its mouth; gives it back once, in the speaker's own voice.	Module 5, at the Standing Water
Road-token	Cut from a Willing Road waystone. Explains itself no more than the road does.	DM's discretion
Kept Season seeds	A small stand holds whatever season the seeds were sown in.	DM's discretion

RECURRING NPCs

Named NPCs the campaign's own modules flag as "open threads" — built to be brought back, not to be used once and discarded. Three (the Ward, the Magistrate, the Regent) are members of Elduvaine's royal house and deliberately carry no proper name yet, and naming them is a decision this campaign has not yet made.

Name	Introduced	Role
Xavier III of Harrowmark	1	The calling king. Leads in person; not yet the Wyvernheart until Module 7.
Huntmaster Brenna Vane (dwarf)	1	Greywatch's huntmaster, two centuries old; runs the wyvern hunt; a recurring source of camp levity.
Sera Vosk (rock gnome)	2A	Auberitz quartermaster; a standing logistics and information contact.
Garrick Hollow (half-elf)	2B	Hired mountain guide; a standing source for overland routes and rumor.

Name	Introduced	Role
Wyn Alder (gnome)	3	An occupation-era clerk at the Landfall checkpoint; the campaign's first answer to what an ordinary complicit person looks like.
Doria Kell (tiefling)	4	Norvatch factor, and the campaign's second-largest lever. Her house has been buying Elduvaine by weight for three years; her ledgers are the clock. Names her price in Module 10.
The Ward (half-elf)	4	Royal house, freed at Sennoch Hall. Precise rather than broken; a standing voice for what the liberated want.
Tam Ondry	5	Harrowmark courier attached to the lost column; a standing source for news arriving from elsewhere.
Marshal Ossian Drell (hobgoblin)	6	Commands Vindana's garrison; a legionary professional on a contract, not a fanatic. Fate resolved in Module 7.
The Magistrate (gnome)	8	Royal house, freed in Vindana; the Ward's great-aunt by marriage. Fought her captivity with bureaucratic warfare and won.
General Ilyana Voss (orc)	9	Commands Vale's field army; came up through the same legion as Drell. Fate resolved this module; a captured Voss is a real long-term asset.
The Regent (human)	10	Royal house, at large; runs what resistance survives and refuses evacuation. See the sourcebook.
Maedoc Vale	11	The wizard. Appears in person only here. Whether he is still human is deliberately unresolved.

THE BRANCH LEDGER

Every tracked divergence across the campaign, compiled from each module's own Diverging Paths (DM Only) section. Fill in the last column at the table, as it happens — this is the record that makes the campaign replayable rather than a railroad with scenery, and it is the reason this document is single-column: these rows need the width.

Module	Divergence	Options	What Actually Happened
1	The wyvern's fate	Killed · driven off · roped and released	
1	Branch Ledger entry 1: the road choice	Sea road (2A) · Mountain road (2B)	
2A	How Thane's hold is settled	Paid off · talked down · fought	
2A	Calanthe's fate	Garrisoned · independent · hybrid	
2B	What the ford cost	A wagon · a delay · a near-miss · an actual loss	
2B	How Vell's toll was settled	Paid · talked down · bypassed · fought	
3	How the party treated Wyn Alder	Threatened · ignored · understood	

Module	Divergence	Options	What Actually Happened
3	Whether the checkpoint turned violent	Yes (word reaches Caer Ysolde early) • No	
4	How Sennoch Hall was resolved	Stealth • violence • a mix	
4	The party's standing with Doria Kell	Face value • pressed for more • suspicion	
5	Branch Ledger entry 1, resolved	The party's own crossing, set against the second king's	
5	How the party engaged with the mourning at the Standing Water	Spoke at the water • listened only • kept apart	
6	How the engines were raised	Smoothly • roughly	
6	The supply raid's outcome	Clean success • failed or messy	
6	How First Assault was fought	Clear local win • costly draw • real loss	
7	How Marshal Drell's fate was resolved	Surrendered • killed • fled	
7	Scene 3: as written, or a direct dragon fight	As written • direct dragon fight	
8	How the Magistrate was freed	Caper • force	
8	Whether the party noticed the pressed clerk	Yes • No	
9	Which Scene 2 was run	Tam's death • the third-thread alternate	
9	General Voss's fate	Killed • captured • fled	
10	Whether Xavier signed Norvatch's contract	Signed • refused • deferred	
10	What the party told the Regent, and what the Regent told them	(Private DM note – not mechanically tracked)	
11	The campaign's final choice	Held • set down	
11	Vale's fate	Killed • escaped • captured	

The final choice draws on everything above it – before running Module 11's Scene 4, a DM may find it worth reading back across this whole ledger with the table.